

How Healthy Are Our Neighbourhoods?

Access to Healthy Assets and Hazards



Access to Healthy Assets and Hazards

Where We Live Affects our Health

The GeoDS Access to Healthy Assets and Hazards (AHAH) index is an openly available data product summarising the accessibility (distance) to various health-promoting and health-damaging features of the built environment across Great Britain. The index synthesises accessibility into a single composite score, and comprises four thematic domains:

- **Health services:** GPs, hospitals, pharmacies, dentists, leisure centres
- **Green and blue space:** Passive greenspace, active greenspace, blue space
- **Air quality:** NO₂, PM₁₀, SO₂
- **Retail outlets:** fast food outlets, gambling venues, pubs and bars, vape and tobacco retailers

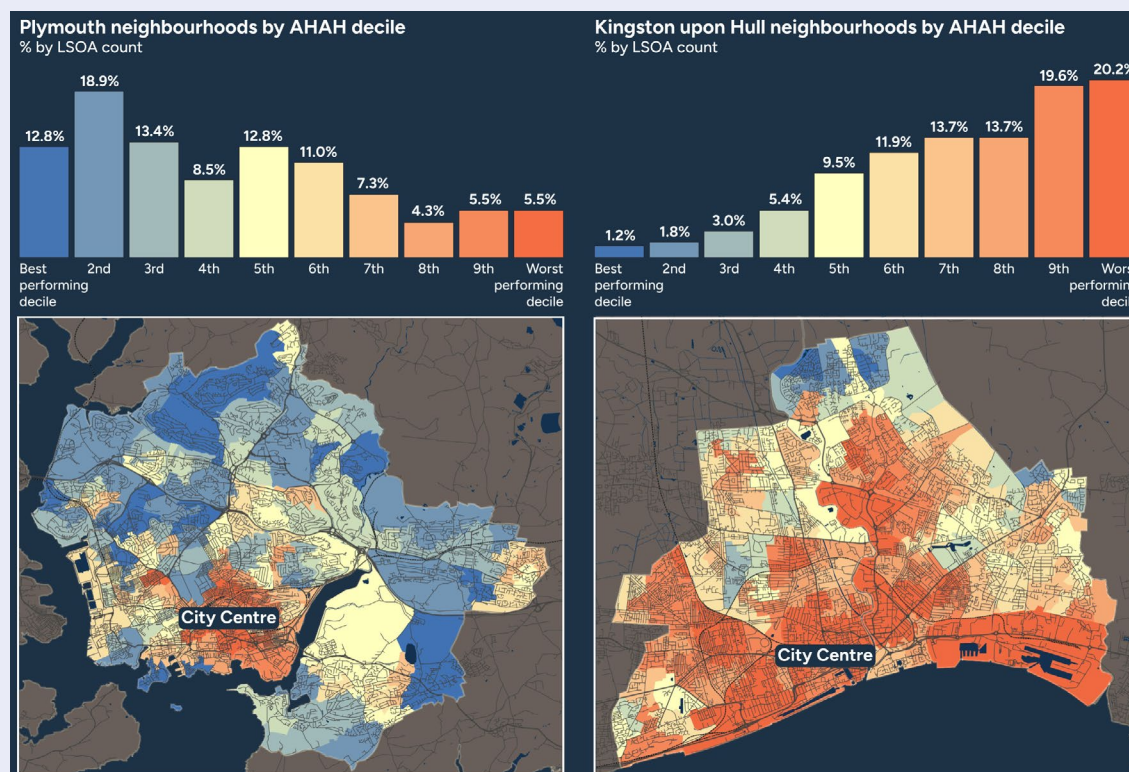
An Environmental Health Atlas of Great Britain

The AHAH index provides insight into how Great Britain's geography contributes to our health outcomes. Measurement data, ranks and percentiles for the overall index, four domains and 15 input indicators are produced at the small-area level using 2021/22 census geographies. Detailed information on the index methodology and taxonomy is available on the GeoDS website at data.geods.ac.uk and data can be viewed at mapmaker.geods.ac.uk.

The index, and its constituent components, provides an effective tool for local planning and benchmarking of health-related interventions and services.

A Tale of Two Port Cities: Plymouth and Kingston upon Hull

Plymouth and Kingston upon Hull are two port cities in England with similar population sizes and densities, yet they exhibit stark differences in the 'health' of their neighbourhoods. At the time of the 2021 Census, Plymouth was the second-most densely populated local authority area in the South West, with a population of around 264,700. Hull was the most densely populated local authority area in Yorkshire and The Humber, with a population of around 267,000. Comparing AHAH deciles at the Lower layer Super Output Area (LSOA) level reveals that more than half of Hull's neighbourhoods rank among the three worst performing deciles, with the city's few 'healthier' neighbourhoods clustered along its boundaries. Plymouth, by contrast, has a much wider distribution of neighbourhoods, and more than two-fifths of its neighbourhoods rank among the three best performing deciles.



Public Health at Your Fingertips

The Office for Health Improvement & Disparities has integrated the AHAH indicator into its 'Fingertips' tool (fingertips.phe.org.uk). This provides public health stakeholders with a rich evidence base that spans a range of health and well-being themes.



All data are openly available to download from data.geods.ac.uk and visible through our interactive web mapping tool: mapmaker.geods.ac.uk